

Ingres VectorWise was launched last month, globally and in India, and we already have customers using the product. Please go to <http://www.ingres.com/vectorwise/> for any information. We are already talking to customers and partners in India about this technology and are seeing a very high level of interest.

Q How is VectorWise different from SybaseIQ?

SybaseIQ is a very capable Analytics DBMS which leverages column-based technology as well as compression technologies. Ingres VectorWise uses the very latest column and compression technologies but where it really differentiates itself is in the areas of chip cache management (as opposed to the much slower RAM- and disk-based approach of its competitors) and vectorisation (utilising the multi-threaded nature of today's modern chip architectures). All of these technologies are embedded in an enterprise grade RDBMS which makes it robust and easy to use. These factors make Ingres VectorWise so much faster and easier to use than anything else on the market. The solution is very simple and we encourage customers to download the product from <http://www.ingres.com/vectorwise/> and give it a try.

Q Do you have products for business critical applications? Could you share some real or run time examples in or outside India? We would also like to know about the potential customers you are targeting in this space?

Ingres database is our enterprise grade open source database that's being used to run some of the world's most business critical highly transactional applications. These include online tax filing and processing systems for a country's tax authority; a micro-processor chip production application; an airport station control system for a major airline; an airline scheduling and planning application serving hundreds of airlines; one of the largest police custody suite applications; core and online banking applications for a leading bank, etc.

Examples of such customers include the Irish Revenue Commissioners, Cathay Pacific, Global Collect, Banca IFIS, Cypress Semiconductors, Lufthansa Aeronautical System, Peerless Foods, Business Standard, Honeywell, an e-District Project for the Government of India (GoI), an ERP implementation, workflow management and portal for a GoI organisation, etc. Ingres' database can be used as a true low cost enterprise-grade open source alternative by all large and small enterprises that currently use expensive proprietary solutions. Our other solution, Ingres VectorWise, is for customers who want to analyse massive volumes of data very quickly, cost effectively and easily. Typical customers of our analytical database would be in telecom, financial services, retail, government citizen data, etc.,—wherever you would need to analyse massive amounts of data.

Q Is there a training-related business model too at Ingres, like at Red Hat? Any certifications?

Ingres Corporation does have an Education Services division through which we have trained many systems integration partners and customers in India. We continue to expand these offerings and have found that the Ingres database is easy to learn and cross training from other RDBMSs is particularly easy.

Q Do you think training is the best way to spread the word about the product?

Yes, we totally agree with the fact that if we have more certified database experts on Ingres it will be easier to get a bigger foothold in the market. But to start with, we have various community activities that are at the core of adding capabilities into the database. We have many programmes like the one in Jordan, plus we have a strong relationship with Red Hat which has great experience in this domain.

Q Do you look at Sun's acquisition by Oracle as a good sign for Ingres?

Oracle's business model is clearly more of a financial consolidator today. We have seen a lot of Sun resources and particularly MySQL skills leave the company since the acquisition, as there is clearly a cultural rift between Oracle and open source. I think this is sad for the OSS community but such is the beauty of the OSS model that you can never really kill off a project if there is a motivated community behind it. Since the acquisition, Ingres has seen a great deal of interest from the broader community as well as from customers and ISVs using MySQL, who are uncomfortable with the future direction of MySQL under Oracle's stewardship.

Q With MySQL entering into a 'grey-zone', firms like EnterpriseDB have upped their ante to promote open source solutions like Postgres in India. How do you plan to handle such a scenario?

I believe the market here in India can easily support multiple OSS RDBMS offerings, and I welcome this as it creates a more healthy competitive landscape. Here, at Ingres, we believe we are the leader if you need enterprise OSS RDBMS, and as we continue to expand our capabilities and deliver more innovation such as Ingres Vectorwise, we will see this leadership increase.

Q Does Ingres have a solution for the embedded segment too?

Yes, we have a large number of customers in the embedded segment as well. There was a very recent case in the electronics industry wherein an electronics scales manufacturer, Mettler Toledo, selected Ingres' compact database for use inside its devices. Any organisation that needs an embedded database with enterprise features, stability and world-class support can utilise Ingres' database. 